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Nvidia said to be
developing new, more
powerful AI chip for sale
in China

nvidia

Ram Iyer — 5:58 AM PDT · August 19, 2025

The world's most valuable chipmaker is far from giving up its desire to retain China as a key growth market. Nvidia is apparently putting together a new AI chip meant for sale in China that's half as powerful as its flagship B300 Blackwell GPU, Reuters [reported](#), citing anonymous sources.

This new chip, codenamed B30A, would be more powerful than the H20 GPUs the company is currently allowed to sell to China, the report said, though its design will be single-die in nature, unlike the dual-die design used in the more powerful B300 GPUs. The B30A would still have similar features to the H20, like fast data transmission, support for NVLink, and high-bandwidth memory.

IMAGE CREDITS:
AP/WIDE WORLD PHOTOS

The development of the B30A seems to be separate from [another chip](#) that the company is said to be developing for sale in the country, Reuters reported.

“We evaluate a variety of products for our roadmap, so that we can be prepared to compete to the extent that governments allow. Everything we offer is with the full approval of the applicable authorities and designed solely for beneficial commercial use,” Nvidia said in an emailed statement.

The news comes as the Trump administration in recent weeks has [relaxed its stance](#) on letting chipmakers export high-performance AI chips to China, though Reuters cited its sources as saying that approvals for this new chip aren't certain at all.

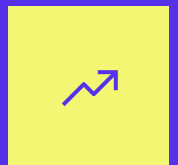
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As geopolitical tensions between Beijing and Washington are increasingly affected by the race to develop AI, critics [argue](#) that the U.S. must maintain its lead by controlling the supply of necessary technology to China. But Nvidia and its peers — finding themselves [selling the equivalent of shovels during a gold rush](#) — maintain that ceding the valuable market of China to rivals like Huawei would be tantamount to giving up entirely.

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Ram is a financial and tech reporter and editor. He covered North American and European M&A, equity, regulatory...

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ENTERPRISE

SoftBank makes \$2B investment in Intel

Kirsten Korosec — 5:23 PM PDT · August 18, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS:

ALEX WROBLEWSKI/BLOOMBERG / GETTY IMAGES

Japanese conglomerate SoftBank has agreed to make a \$2 billion investment in Intel in a deal described as a commitment to advanced technology and semiconductors in the United States.

The agreement, in which SoftBank will buy Intel common stock, [was announced Monday](#) after markets closed. SoftBank will pay \$23 per share of Intel common stock. Shares of Intel, which closed at \$23.66, popped more than 5% in after-hours trading.

SoftBank Group Chairman and CEO Masayoshi Son said in a statement that the “strategic investment reflects our belief that advanced semiconductor manufacturing and supply will further expand in the United States, with Intel playing a critical role.”

The investment provides validation for Intel, which has been overshadowed in recent years by competitors like Nvidia. It also reflects SoftBank’s renewed interest in the U.S., particularly around AI chips. SoftBank recently [purchased a factory](#) in Lordstown, Ohio, owned by Foxconn, as part of a plan to build AI data centers.

Intel, steered by new CEO Lip-Bu Tan, is in the midst of a restructuring that aims to streamline the semiconductor business and focus on its core client and data center portfolio. Earlier this summer, Intel [shuttered its automotive architecture business](#) and laid off most of its staff. It also announced plans to reduce its Intel Foundry division workforce [between 15% and 20%](#).

Tan has also had to navigate political landmines in recent weeks as President Donald Trump [called for his resignation](#) due to conflicts of interest — an accusation that was made without evidence — and his administration reportedly had discussions to [take a stake in Intel](#).

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The SoftBank-Intel deal comes just days after the Trump administration threatened [new tariffs](#) on imported semiconductor chips as part of his strategy to boost domestic production.



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IMAGE CREDITS: GOOGLE

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Pixel 10, AI capabilities, and everything else we expect out of the Made by Google 2025 event

Lauren Forristal — 9:30 AM PDT · August 18, 2025

As anticipation builds for the [Made by Google 2025 event](#), there's a buzz around the Pixel 10 series, arriving notably before the [iPhone 17](#). Apple's [hardware event](#) is expected to take place in September.

The tech giant has made its intentions clear to grow the Pixel line, likely incorporating more generative AI capabilities with Gemini. Made by Google starts at 10 a.m. PT on Wednesday.

Get ready for a Gemini boost

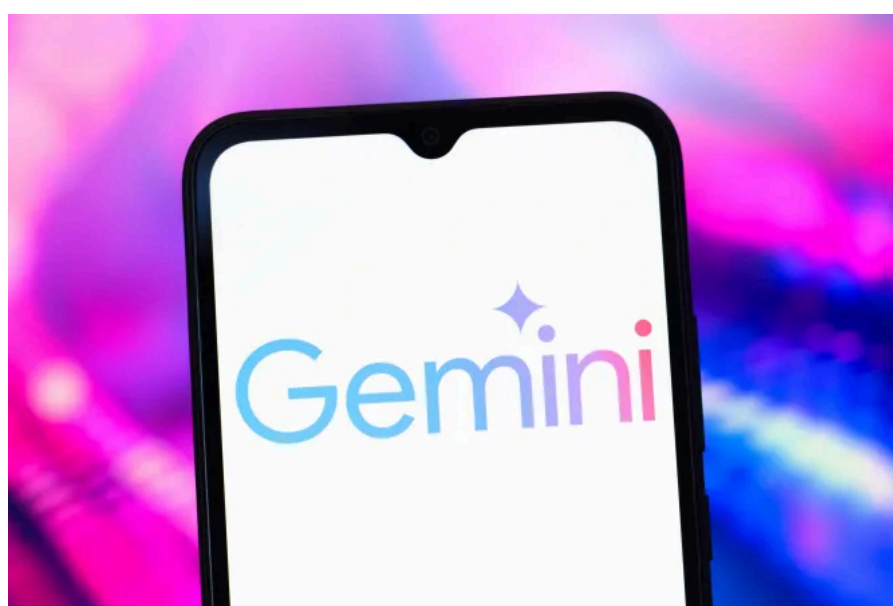


IMAGE CREDITS: THOMAS FULLER/SOPA IMAGES/LIGHTROCKET / GETTY IMAGES

Google already dropped several AI-related updates at its [developer conference](#) in May, but the company will likely demonstrate more Gemini features during the Pixel 10 event. In a recent [YouTube video](#) promoting the new devices, Google even seemed to poke fun at Apple's failed promises with Apple Intelligence advancements on the iPhone.

[Rumors](#) are buzzing about a feature called "Camera Coach," which would let Gemini give you real-time tips for taking better photos. The AI is supposedly able to see what's going on and suggest the best angles and lighting for your shot.

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Made by Google 2025: How to watch Google debut the Pixel 10, Pixel Watch 4, and more

Lauren Forristal

- 23 hours ago

There's also talk of a [conversational photo editing tool](#), where you tell Gemini what you want to tweak in a photo, such as increasing the brightness, removing objects, or changing the background.

Google Pixel 10 | Soon



Pixel 10, 10 Pro, and 10 Pro XL

The standard Pixel 10 phone is expected to undergo significant changes, particularly with the addition of a dedicated telephoto lens, a feature that was previously exclusive to the Pro models. Following the leak of renders showcasing the third rear lens, [Google released a teaser for the Pixel 10](#), confirming the substantial camera upgrade.

Additionally, all phones in the lineup are expected to be powered by a new Tensor G5 processor, ushering in the Gemini era and enhancing performance and power efficiency compared to the Tensor G4 chip.



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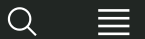
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the same, with the Pixel 10 and Pixel 10 Pro featuring a 6.3-inch display, and the Pixel 10 Pro XL with a larger 6.8-inch display.

Some areas where the Pro models may see improvement are camera and video quality, along with battery size, which could allow for faster charging and could address the longevity gap between Pixel and flagship phones from Apple and Samsung.

Plus, there is talk that the Pixel 10 series could support [Qi2 wireless charging](#). If true, this means it would be one of the few Android phones to work with magnetic accessories, such as chargers, wallets, and mounts. Google is also reportedly launching a “Pixelsnap” phone case with a magnetic ring in the center.

Pixel 10 Pro Fold

As for Google's upcoming foldable, there are rumors suggesting it'll have a larger cover display, measuring at around 6.4 inches, alongside an 8-inch main screen. Additionally, Google is reportedly enhancing the strength of the hinge, and the bezels are expected to be thinner for a sleek appearance.

Another exciting rumor is the possibility of an [IP68 rating](#), a first for the device. (And according to leaked specs, [this may in fact be coming](#).) This means it can stand up to both dust and water, whereas the Pixel 9 Pro Fold has zero dust protection.

... pic.twitter.com/iJdzbRaDgK

— Evan Blass (@evleaks) [August 7, 2025](#)

Like the other Pixel 10 phones, the Pro Fold will likely be powered by the new G5 chip and include the latest Gemini AI features. The camera system might also receive improvements, potentially featuring a 48-megapixel ultra-wide lens and a telephoto lens with 5x optical zoom. The phone should also likely get a bump in battery life.

The Pixel 10 may come in Moonstone and Jade colors.

The Pixel Watch and Pixel Buds



IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

Wearables will also get their time to shine at Google’s event, with the Pixel Watch 4 rumored to get a thicker design, a longer battery life, and smaller bezels.

There’s also a strong likelihood that the smartwatch will introduce new health and fitness-tracking capabilities, possibly including an upgraded [blood oxygen \(SpO2\) monitoring](#) function.

[Leaks](#) of the Pixel Buds 2a indicate that the earbuds will come in new colors (Fog Light, Hazel, Iris, and Strawberry) along with [features](#) like active noise cancellation. The Pixel Buds Pro 2 will also reportedly come in a new Sterling color.

This story has been updated to include additional rumors.

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Eight Sleep raises \$100M to expand its AI-powered sleep tech

Roughly [one in three adults in the U.S. regularly gets insufficient sleep](#), driving demand for tools that can monitor, analyze, and enhance rest. [Eight Sleep](#), founded in 2014, offers AI-powered sleep tech products that promise to transform your bed into a preventive health device.

The New York-based startup announced Tuesday that it raised a fresh \$100 million round from investors such as HSG, Valor Equity Partners, Founders Fund, Y Combinator and athletes including Ferrari F1 driver Charles Leclerc, and Zak Brown, who is the CEO of McLaren F1.

With this round, Eight Sleep has raised roughly \$260 million total, Pitchbook estimates. It previously raised an \$86 million Series C in 2021 by investors who assigned it a [\\$500 million post-money valuation](#). Eight Sleep said its valuation has doubled since its last round, but didn't disclose specifics.

"If we successfully execute our AI roadmap, launch internationally, and develop condition-specific interventions, achieving unicorn status will naturally follow," Alexandra Zatarain, co-founder and CMO of Eight Sleep, told TechCrunch.

Eight offers smart mattresses that integrate software and AI to track and enhance sleep quality. Its flagship product, Pod, offers features like measuring sleep stages, heart rate, breathing patterns, and movement. Using these insights, it automatically adjusts temperature, elevation, and



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firmness. It can also detect snoring and automatically elevate the base in response, according to the company.

The company has generated more than \$500 million in Pod sales, expanded its revenue tenfold since launching the product in 2019, and collected insights from over one billion hours of recorded sleep data, it says.

Eight, which employs just over 100 full-time staff, is now expanding beyond the Pod with its Sleep Agent, an AI-driven system that leverages large language models to create thousands of digital twins for each user and predict outcomes, with the goal of optimizing nightly recovery. This approach shifts sleep technology from reactive tracking to proactive, personalized intervention, said Zatarain.

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The sleep tech market features a range of competitors, from wearable devices such as Oura, Fitbit, and Apple, to medical-focused companies like ResMed, as well as smart mattress and sleep

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surface makers, including Sleep Number and ChiliSleep.

Eight's core differentiator, Autopilot, "builds a personal blueprint from night one, then adapts continuously, accounting for seasonality, travel, stress, training, illness, or even a bad night before. And it works independently for each side of the bed," Zatarain said.

The startup plans to use the new funding to accelerate its growth in the medical sector, building on the Pod's health-monitoring capabilities. With the introduction of Health Check, the system can monitor cardiovascular and respiratory patterns with up to 99% accuracy without the need for wearable devices, according to the company.

"We're not replacing your doctor, but we are giving you nightly, high-accuracy health monitoring so you can act early if trends shift. Over time, this data can complement medical care," Zatarain said.

Eight's recently launched [Hot Flash Mode](#) employs AI-driven cooling to relieve menopause symptoms. It is also working on contactless solutions for sleep apnea. The company is pursuing FDA approval and will utilize the Pod's real-time biometric monitoring to deliver personalized interventions.

Eight Sleep currently ships to over 30 countries—including Canada, the UK and EU nations, Australia, Mexico, and the UAE—and is now planning to expand into China. The CMO told TechCrunch that China, as one of the world's largest consumer markets, is seeing a rise in a health-conscious middle class that prioritizes sleep and overall wellness.

Regarding sensitive health data, Zatarain said the company complies with each locale's regulations, including for data storage.

“Privacy is foundational. All data is encrypted, never sold, and fully private. We comply with GDPR and CCPA, and unlike many devices, we don’t use microphones. Our biometric sensors are embedded in the bed surface — no wearables, no invasiveness, just passive, high-accuracy insights,” Zatarain said.

Topics: [AI](#) [Eight Sleep](#) [Fundraising](#) [North America](#)

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Kate Park

Reporter, Asia |

Kate Park is a reporter at TechCrunch, with a focus on technology, startups and venture capital in Asia. She...

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